

The background of the entire page is a blue-tinted photograph of a soccer stadium. In the foreground, the back of a person's head and shoulders are visible, with their arms raised in celebration. The stadium seating is filled with spectators, and a soccer field is visible in the middle ground.

2026

Sports Media Planning Guide

A guide to reaching and converting the most valuable consumers through the lens of sports.



The fan journey is always on, and fandom itself is fluid.

This guide is designed to equip you with a strategic framework for planning, activating, and optimizing how your brand connects with consumers in 2026 through the lens of the world’s most valuable entertainment ecosystem: sports.

In the pages that follow, we bring the full 2026 sports calendar to life, highlighting unique audiences, seasonal behaviors, and activation opportunities. All of the insights and audiences are powered by the industry’s only consumer data cloud rooted in deterministic, observed fan behavior, enabling agencies and brands to plan and execute with confidence, precision at scale, and measurable impact.

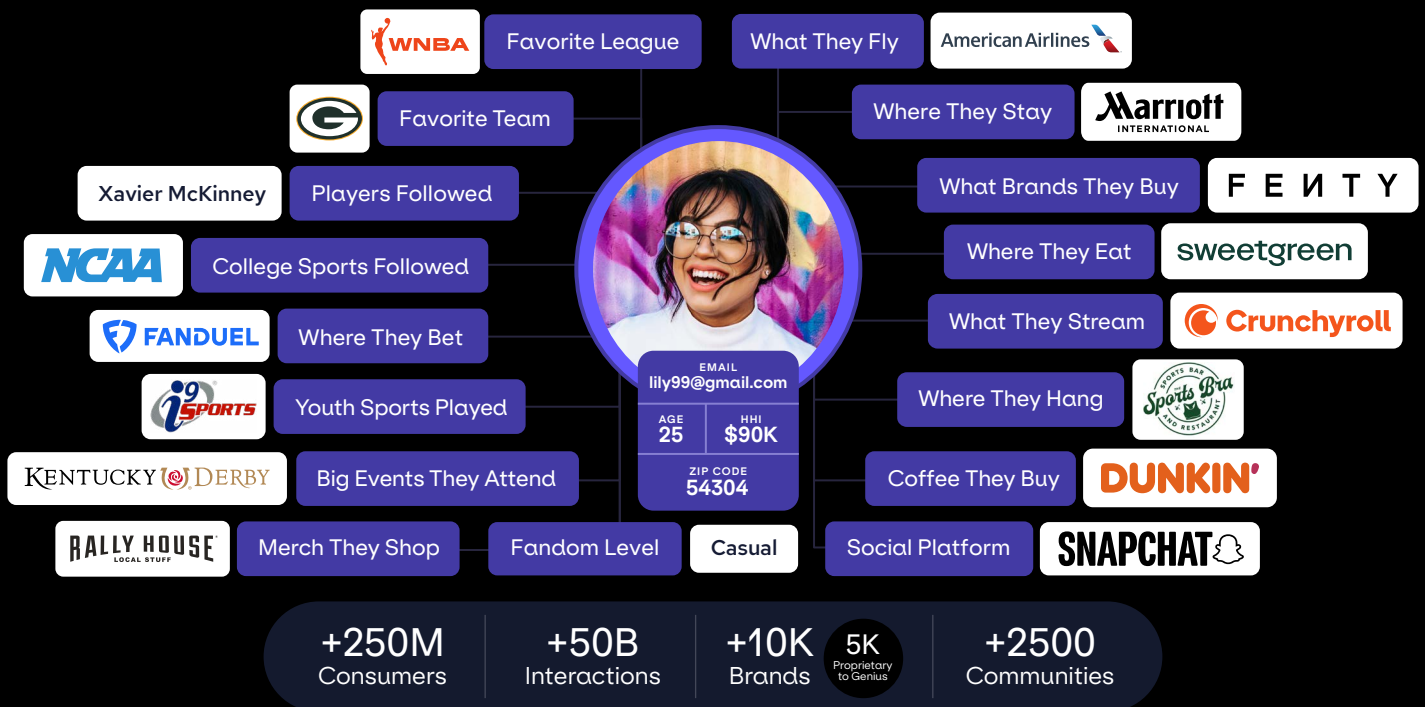


IF YOU'RE A	YOU'LL FIND
Brand Marketer	Consumer and fan insights to help guide your segmentation strategies, as well as your media and sponsorship investment plans around tentpole sporting events.
Media Agency Strategist, Planner, or Buyer	Fan insights and in-market activation opportunities with our addressable audiences and custom Fluid Fan™ communities aligned to shopper/category seasonality and tentpole sporting events.
Programmatic or Audience Buyer	Detailed explanations on how we design, prioritize, and deploy our best-in-class programmatic audiences which are built from deterministic data and our proprietary modeling.
Consumer Insights Practitioner	Insights on trending fan behaviors and our outlook on the most valuable fan communities for 2026, as well as how to translate those insights into in-market activation.

The Genius Fan Graph

The only consumer data cloud purpose-built for sports

Move from broad generalized fanbases to understanding individual fans, with deterministic data from official league partnerships, Sports Innovation Lab's consumer data cloud, free-to-play games, and more.



Precision

- Always-on, passively collected data with deterministic accuracy and granularity
- Direct, privacy-safe link between data and real consumer behavior (anonymous ID)

Relevance

- Buyer intent, content/viewing, and purchase behavior
- Demographic signals to inform targeting and optimization

Scale

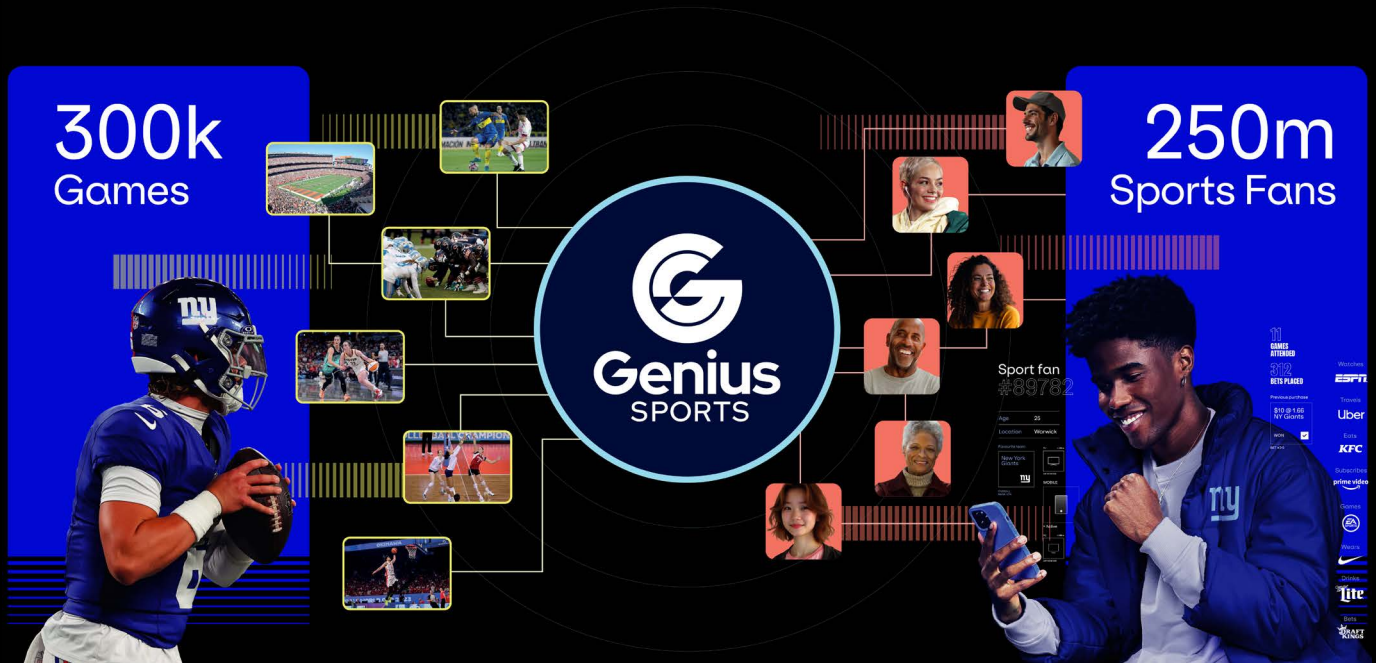
- Comprehensive U.S. identity coverage with five years of longitudinal data for stability and learning
- Cross-channel, cross-device identification for unified activation and measurement

FROM CONTEXT...

...TO AUDIENCE...

...TO THE NEXT FRONTIER...

Welcome to the Moment Economy



Genius Sports makes true moment-based activation possible

by seeing every moment of the game and connecting that intelligence to a scaled fan graph built specifically for sports. With technology embedded in more than 300 venues, Genius Sports can deliver the right message to the right fan in real time, across channels. And moments do not stop when the game ends. Fandom is always on, extending into highlights, storylines, and cultural moments outside the game and season, allowing brands to stay relevant and connected whenever fan emotion peaks.

EXAMPLE MOMENT-BASED ADVERTISING TRIGGERS

- Event countdowns
- Game time
- Emotional milestones
- Leader at end of game period
- Period changes
- Next game
- Record breaks
- Consumer emotional states
- Player news
- Overtime
- Fan response

2026 Sports & Entertainment Media Planning Calendar

QUARTER	KEY EVENTS	SEASONAL CATEGORIES	GENIUS ACTIVATION IDEAS	PLANNING DEADLINE
Q1	NCAA Bowl Games JAN			Mid November
	Super Bowl FEB 9	- Health & Fitness - Sober Curious - Beauty & Self Care - Valentine's Gifting - Travel - Spring Youth Sports - Sports Betting - Streaming OTT - Food Delivery - Auto - QSR	- NFL Playoffs Stories Sponsorship - Super Bowl Moments Targeting - March Madness GameDay - NBA Stat View Sponsorship - Women's Soccer Fan Audiences	Early December
	Winter Olympics FEB 6 - 22			
	Daytona 500 FEB 16			
Q2	MLS Season Start FEB 22			
	NWSL Season Start MAR			
	F1 Season Start MAR 14 - 16			
	MLB Season Start MAR 18			
Q3	March Madness MAR 18 - APR 7			Early January
	The Masters APR 7-13			
	NHL Playoffs APR - JUN			
	NBA Playoffs APR - JUN			
Q4	WNBA Season Start MAY	- Outdoor Enthusiasts - Home Improvement - Home Entertainment - Apparel - Swimwear - Spring Cleaning - Gardening - Flowers - Spring Break Travel - Sportstainment	- Masters Stories Sponsorship - WNBA Genius Moments - WNBA Stat View Sponsorship - Derby Stories Sponsorship - Custom Sports Bettors Audiences - World Cup Stories Sponsorship	January
	PWHL Playoffs MAY			
	Kentucky Derby MAY 3			
	Indy 500 MAY 25			
Q1	US Women's Open (Golf) MAY 26 - JUN 1			March
	World Cup JUN 11 - JUL 19	- Back to School - Office Supplies - Movie Buffs - Streaming - Theme Parkers - Concert & Festivalists - Apparel - Electronics - Footwear - Sportstainment	- WNBA All-Star Stories Sponsorship - Wimbledon Genius Moments Campaign - Tennis Fan Audiences - NFL Stories Sponsorship - World Cup Moments Campaign - World Cup Persona Audiences	Mid May
	Wimbledon JUN 30 - JUL 13			
	WNBA All Star JUL 18 - 19			
Q2	NFL Season Start SEP			
	US Open (Tennis) AUG 25 - SEP 7			
	WNBA Playoffs SEP - OCT			
	WNBA Playoffs SEP - OCT			
Q3	NHL Season Start OCT	- Automotive - Party & Costume - Health & Wellness (Cold season) - Electronics - Big Box Gifting - Streaming - Sports Merchandise - Skiing - Toys - Beauty - Luxury - Alcohol - Food Delivery	- NFL Genius Moments Campaign - NBA Stat View Sponsorship - MLS Championship Stories Sponsorship - Baseball Fan Audiences	Mid July
	NBA Season Start OCT			
	MLS Cup Playoffs OCT - DEC			
	MLB Playoffs OCT - NOV			
Q4	NWSL Playoffs NOV			
	PWHL Season Start NOV			

College Sports March Madness

Social Spenders

For college basketball fans, the love of play never fades. They're **3x more likely vs. gen pop to spend on social experiences** like Topgolf and Puttshack.

Property Pros

Home is where the game's on, and college basketball fans are putting in the work, with **65% owning homes and spending an avg of \$1.2K/year on home improvement.**

Movie Buffs

From March Madness to movie premieres, 56% of college basketball fans showed their love for entertainment, **spending an avg of \$130/fan per year at the movies.**

The College Basketball Fan

College basketball fans stay deeply engaged throughout March Madness, filling out brackets, joining office pools, betting through PrizePicks, and tracking every upset and buzzer-beater across multiple screens. They blend their love of competition with social connection, grabbing McDonald's on the way to watch parties and showing up in Fanatics merch. For these fans, March Madness isn't just a tournament, it's a shared cultural moment that brings friends and rivals together.



Categories Where College Basketball Fans Are Spending

Actual brands purchased by College Basketball Fans as identified by the Genius Fan Graph

Category penetration among College Basketball Fans

Recommended Audiences

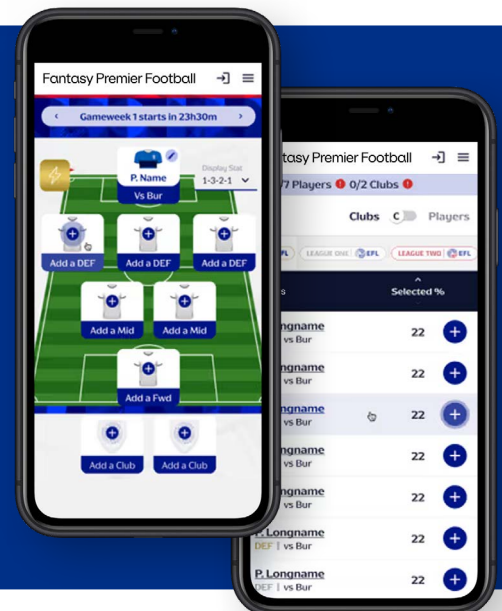
- Sportstainment Lovers
- Home Depot Shoppers
- Lowe's Shoppers
- AMC Theater Customers
- On-Demand Movie Spenders
- Domestic Decorators
- Entrepreneurs & Small Business Owners
- Lululemon Shoppers
- College Basketball Fans Who Bet
- Women's College Basketball Fans & Viewers
- High Frequency Coffee Spenders

SEARCH GENIUS SPORTS AUDIENCES

ACTIVATION IDEA

Second-Screen Games

As fans track every upset and compare brackets, interactive predictors and trivia powered by Genius Second-Screen Games create repeat engagement while capturing high-quality first-party data throughout the tournament.



The Olympic Fan

The Olympics unite a broader, more diverse audience than traditional sports moments, drawing in fans who show up for global stories, breakthrough athletes, and once-in-a-generation competition. Only the Genius Fan Graph has verified deterministic Olympic fans across more than 20 sports, giving brands and agencies an opportunity to connect with audiences who may not follow sports year-round, but are deeply engaged when the world comes together on this stage.



Women's Sports Fans

Olympic women's sports fans show up for the movement, championing the athletes redefining what the global sports stage looks like.

Audiences

- Women's Sports Streamers
- Women's College Sports Fans
- NWSL Fans
- WNBA Fans
- LPGA Fans
- PWHL Fans
- AU Softball Fans
- Youth Sports Parents that are also Women's Sports Fans



International Sports Fans

Nationality drives key viewership and engagement for these fans that prioritize and value rallying behind their home country.

Audiences

- FIFA World Cup Fans
- Olympic Sports Fans
- Olympic Winter Sports Fans
- Premier League Fans
- La Liga Fans
- EFL Championship Fans
- UEFA Fans
- Rugby Fans
- International Sports Streamers
- International Sports Bettors



Emerging Sports Fans

Emerging sports fans use the Olympics as a primary access point to follow niche sports, where year-round coverage and regular streaming opportunities are limited.

Audiences

- Pro Bull Riding Fans
- X Games Fans
- Cricket Fans
- Figure Skating Fans
- Gymnastics Fans
- Premier Lacrosse League
- League One Volleyball
- Intramural Pickleball Players
- Professional Pickleball Fans
- Emerging Sports Streamers

 [SEARCH GENIUS SPORTS AUDIENCES](#)

MLB

Cap Collectors

Whether it's for game-day or every day, MLB fans can't resist a good cap! They are **2x more likely to purchase hats** from retailers like Lids than the average consumer.

Theme Parkers

MLB fans bring their sense of play everywhere as they're **44% more likely than the average consumer to visit theme parks** like Disney World, Universal, and SeaWorld.

Everyday Athletes

In 2024, MLB fans proved they're experience seekers, **averaging \$1.2K per fan on activities** like skiing, bowling, golf, and pickleball.

The MLB Fan

MLB fans blend timeless tradition with modern taste, staying loyal to their league and enjoying a new generation of baseball with youth sports. They travel with American Airlines to catch matchups on the road, shop for quality apparel and hats that showcase their team pride, and stock up at Bass Pro Shops for their next summer outdoor adventure. Whether they're enjoying a game-day drink or reaching for their favorite sober-curious brand Hiyo, these fans pair nostalgia with a modern sense of lifestyle and community.



Recommended Audiences

- Sports Merchandise Shoppers
- Lids Shoppers
- Theme Park Goers
- Disney World or Disneyland Visitors
- Emerging Sports Fans
- High-Value Baseball Fans
- Mini Golf & Topgolf Spenders
- Youth Baseball Parents
- Frequent Pickleball Players
- Amateur Sports Enthusiasts
- Sober Curious MLB Fans
- Breaking T Baseball Fans

[SEARCH GENIUS SPORTS AUDIENCES](#)

ACTIVATION IDEA

Genius Moments

When baseball's defining plays spark emotional highs, real-time triggers activate personalized creative via Genius Moments, allowing brands to reach fans precisely when attention and excitement peak.

The image shows a mobile app interface for a baseball game. At the top, it displays the score: LAD 4, TOR 4, with 9 innings and 2 outs. Below the score, there's a promotional offer: 'TAKE 20% OFF' for Drivo. The Drivo logo is at the bottom.

NWSL

Trend Seekers

Women's soccer fans are trendy! **80% of fans shop Gen Z's top brands**, including spending almost \$200/year with Ulta.

Ultra Altruistic

For NWSL fans, passion and purpose go hand-in-hand. They are over **3x more likely than the general population to be values driven**.

Luxury Lifters

From boutique pilates studios to state-of-the-art gyms, they're **4.5x more likely to visit luxury fitness clubs**, spending more than \$850 per fan on passes and memberships.

The NWSL Fan

Women's soccer fans are 58% more likely than other women's sports fans to buy from brands that show up for the game*, proving how purpose fuels loyalty. They shop at Ulta, Amazon and Ikea, pairing practicality with personal expression, and invest in their wellbeing through boutique gyms that match their active, aspirational lifestyle.

*Source: Parity, August 2025



Categories Where NWSL Fans Are Spending

Actual brands purchased by NWSL Fans as identified by the Genius Fan Graph

Recommended Audiences

- Trendsetters
- Gen-Z NWSL Fans
- High-Value Soccer Fans
- Teen Apparel Retail Shoppers
- Sneakerheads
- Purpose-Driven Athleisure Powerhouses
- Charitable Givers
- Sustainable Brand Buyers
- Gen Z Women's Sports Viewers
- Fitness Class Curators
- Luxury & Premium Fitness Club Members
- Runners & Running Retail Shoppers

ACTIVATION IDEA

Genius Stat View

Genius Stat View enhances NWSL coverage with real-time visual overlays that highlight player movement, key moments, and performance insights, giving brands a premium data-led presence within the live match experience.



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MLS

Frequent Travelers

MLS fans are jet-setting travelers! Each fan **spends more than \$2.7K on air travel per year** and are 3x more likely to shop at airports vs. gen pop.

Club Collectors

Personal identity and fandom are intertwined, with MLS fans nearly **3x more likely than the average consumer to buy sports merch.**

Sports Bettors

MLS fans are high-value bettors, **spending an average of \$4,413 per fan on sports betting.**

The MLS Fan

MLS fans are globally curious, culturally engaged, and always plugged in. They pair deep local loyalty with a global sports appetite, spending an average of \$639 per fan on international sports and preferring American Airlines to get there. They're experience-led and socially driven, as one in three regularly attends concerts and music festivals, seeking out live moments beyond the stadium. Off the pitch, they're highly digital, with 62% showing up as gamers, making them active participants in interactive and online entertainment.



Recommended Audiences

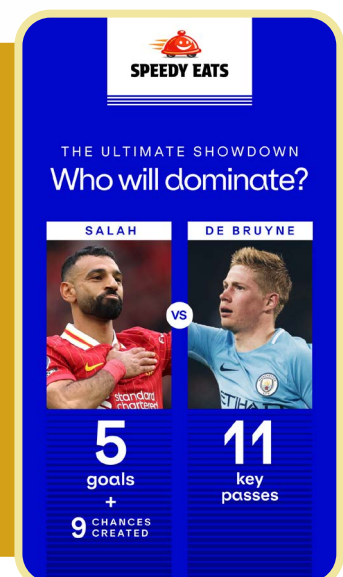
- Domestic or International Airlines Spenders
- Rental Car Shoppers
- Official Merchandise & Branded Apparel Shoppers
- Disney+ Subscribers
- International Sports Fans
- Youth Soccer Parents
- World Cup Fans
- Pop Culture Sports Fans
- National Team Supporters
- Recreational & Amateur Soccer Players
- Ted Lasso & Welcome to Wrexham Watchers

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ACTIVATION IDEA

Second-Screen Games

For globally-minded supporters who thrive on competition, interactive predictors and trivia from Genius Second-Screen Games deepen matchday engagement and generate valuable first-party insights.



NBA

Tech Tastemakers

The NBA fan stays on top of the latest tech, with fans making **more than 30 tech product purchases on average per year!**

Culture Seekers

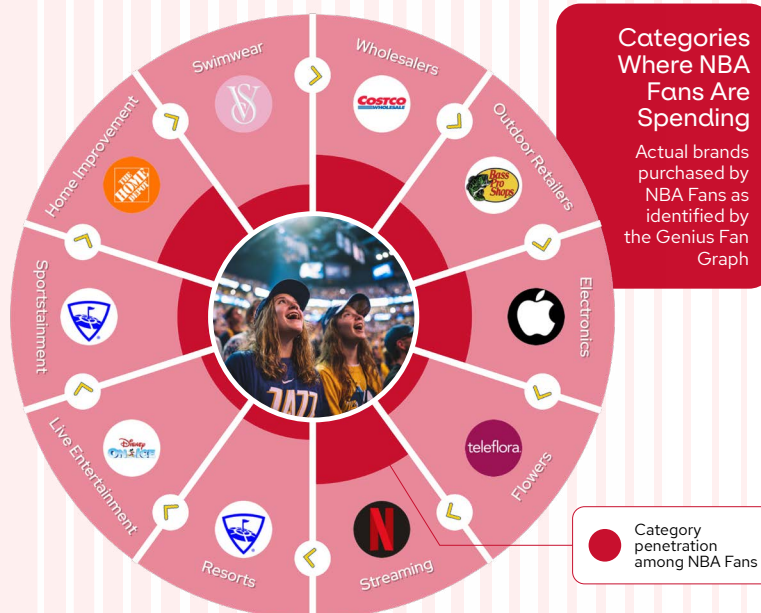
Basketball games are just the start. Compared to the general population, NBA fans are **6x more likely to be festival attendees, and 5x more likely to go to comedy shows.**

Bargain Hunters

It's all about the thrill of a deal for NBA fans. Nearly **half (48.5%) of fans spend at club, warehouse or wholesale retailers.**

The NBA Fan

NBA fans are the heartbeat of sports culture. They're trendsetters who turn every game into a full entertainment experience, early adopters of tech and style who stream highlights nonstop and show up courtside. They're also savvy bargain hunters, with nearly half (48.5%) shopping at club, warehouse, or wholesale retailers. As the regular season wraps and playoffs peak in late spring and summer, NBA fans over-index on warm-weather lifestyles, driving strong spend in categories like swimwear and seasonal apparel. As some of the most culturally influential fans in sports, they deliver premium value for brands and leagues alike.



Recommended Audiences

- Gen-Z Basketball Fans
- NBA Team-Specific Fans
- Tech-Savvy Fans
- Luxury Fashion Shoppers
- Sneakerheads
- High Frequency Electronic Retail Shoppers
- Concert & Festivalists
- Big Box Retail and Club Store Shoppers
- High-Value Live Event Ticket Purchasers

ACTIVATION IDEA

Genius Stat View

With fans consuming highlights at massive scale, AI-driven overlays from Genius Stat View—including shot maps and player IDs—turn data into premium visual storytelling where brands can seamlessly integrate.



 [SEARCH GENIUS SPORTS AUDIENCES](#)

WNBA

Clean Eaters

Pass the green juice. WNBA fans are **2x more likely than the average consumer to be healthy eaters.**

Connected Commuters

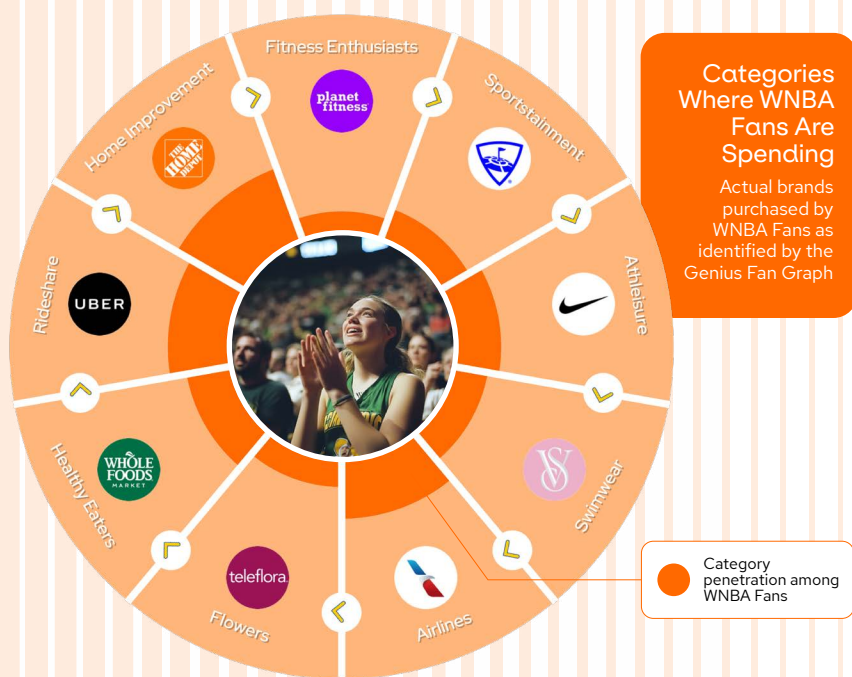
The average WNBA fan **spends \$700 per year on rideshares**, using apps such as Uber or Lyft at least 2x per month.

Wellness-Minded

WNBA fans are **twice as likely as the general population to spend time outdoors**, making nature a part of their wellness-driven mindset.

The WNBA Fan

Women's sports fans are the most Fluid Fans of all, and WNBA fans are the tip of the spear. W fans are purpose-driven trendsetters who are loyal to brands who support the sports and athletes they love. They balance intentional living with convenience, shopping at Whole Foods and staying fit at clubs like Planet Fitness. When it comes to gifting, there isn't a more generous fanbase—WNBA fans show up as the top spenders across all professional leagues during major shopping moments including Mother's Day, Black Friday, and Cyber Monday. This is a high value audience every brand should be paying close attention to!



Recommended Audiences

- Outdoor Enthusiasts
- Skiers
- Sneakerheads
- Protein Fiends
- Wellness Warriors
- Women's Sports OTT Subscribers
- Uber Loyalists
- Mainstream Athleisure Powerhouses
- Sportstainment Lovers
- High-Value Women's Sports Fans
- High-Value WNBA Fans that are Also Sneakerheads

[SEARCH GENIUS SPORTS AUDIENCES](#)

ACTIVATION IDEA

Genius Stories

With players driving fashion, culture, and conversation well beyond the court, Genius Stories delivers real-time, data-led social content that spotlights the moments and personalities fans care about, helping brands authentically align with the WNBA's cultural influence.

deuce

Who will rock the concrete runway?

OR

The Aces Walk The Tunnel @ 5PM This Friday

Golf

Performance Dressers

Golf fans are more than **3x likelier than the average consumer to wear athleisure**, shopping at top brands including Nike, Athleta, and Lululemon.

Flexible Financiers

Golf fans **make an average of 30 payments using Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) platforms**, and are 2x more likely than the gen pop to spend with DTC finance platforms.

Wine and Diners

No special occasion is necessary for golf fans, **as they're 3x more likely than the gen pop to dine out at restaurants, and twice as likely to spend on alcohol.**

The Golf Fan

Golf fans are active, sociable, and intentional in how they spend, blending premium taste with practical habits. They favor Nike for performance apparel and Lids for their go-to headwear, reflecting a polished yet relaxed sense of style. Whether playing a round with friends at Topgolf, networking over 18 holes, or catching major tournaments from home, they embody a lifestyle built on connection, balance, and quality.



Recommended Audiences

- Premium Athleisure Powerhouses
- Home Improvement & Hardware Spenders
- Dollar & Discount Store Shoppers
- Casual Restaurants Goers
- Alcohol Delivery Spenders
- Lids Purchasers
- Sportstainment Lovers
- Dick's Sporting Goods Shoppers
- Sports Bettors
- Youth Sports Parents
- High-Value Golf Fans
- Female Masters Fans

[SEARCH GENIUS SPORTS AUDIENCES](#)

ACTIVATION IDEA

Genius Stat View Custom

Genius Stat View Custom creates bespoke golf visualizations—like shot tracers, ball-flight paths, and course recreations—giving brands an elevated, ownable presence woven directly into premium tournament storytelling.



NHL

Youth Sports Parents

NHL fans are busy coaching from home, spending with youth gear retailers & rec sports leagues at **4x that of the gen pop**, and spending over **\$550 per fan each year**.

Class Curators

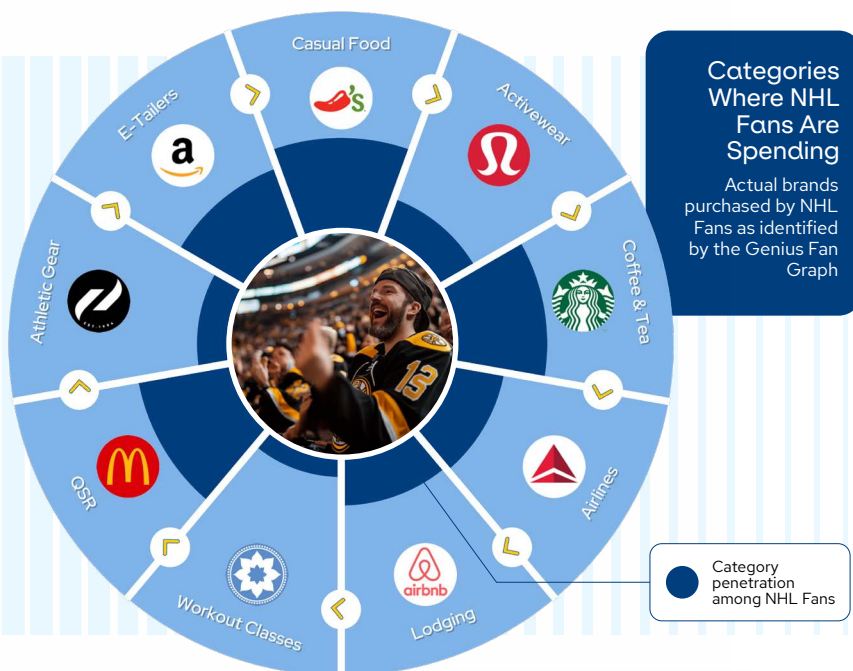
NHL fans thrive on challenge and accountability. They're **2x more likely to take workout classes than have a gym membership**, with an avg spend per fan of **\$800/year**.

Car Caretakers

For tune-ups, NHL fans turn to the pros; they're around **1.5x more likely than the gen pop to spend on oil changes and tire services**.

The NHL Fan

NHL fans are data-driven and engaged well beyond puck drop, closely following matchups, player performance, and odds. That commitment fuels heavy betting activity (averaging 41 deposits per fan and \$2,600 in annual spend) and extends into daily life, where many actively support and invest in youth and recreational sports. NHL fandom is less about casual viewership and more about loyalty by showing up consistently for the game at every level.



Recommended Audiences

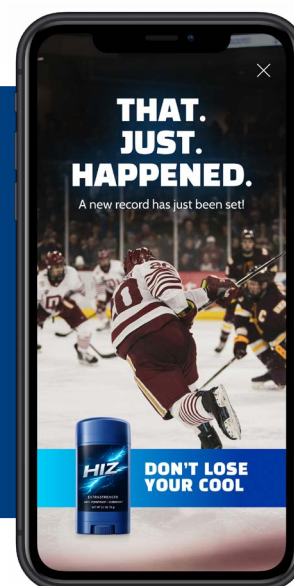
- Back-to-School Shoppers
- Youth Hockey Parents
- At-Home Fitness Enthusiasts
- Amazon Prime Subscribers
- Cyber Monday Deal Seekers
- Tech-Savvy Fans
- Purpose-Driven Athleisure Powerhouses
- Gen-Z NHL Fans
- Hockey Sports Bettors

[SEARCH GENIUS SPORTS AUDIENCES](#)

ACTIVATION IDEA

Genius Moments

During high-intensity shifts, like goals, power plays, and rivalry bursts, real-time triggers from Genius Moments deliver contextually relevant creative at the exact moments fans are most locked in.



PWHL

Pet Parents

65% of PWHL fans are pet owners, spending an average of \$700 annually on pet retail purchases from brands such as PetSmart and Chewy.

Live Entertainment Seekers

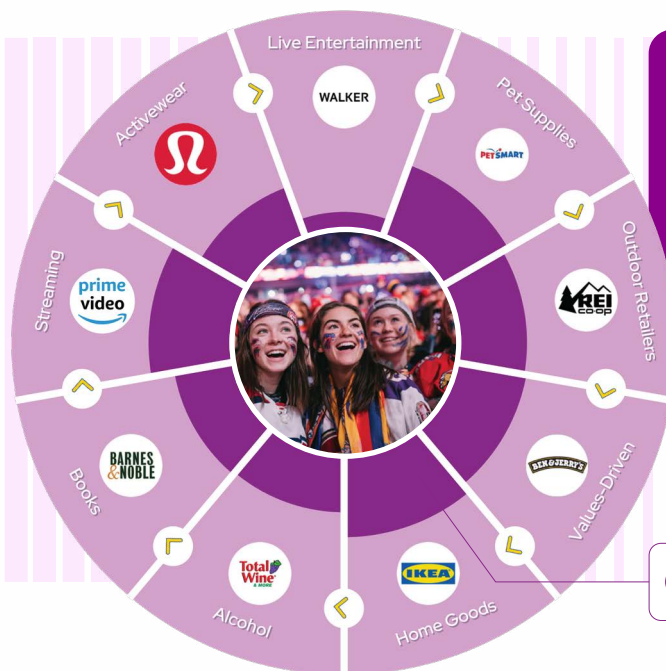
81% are live entertainment seekers and are 2.4x more likely than the average consumer to attend live events. From concerts and comedy shows to theater and orchestra, these fans thrive on shared, in-person experiences.

Conscious Consumers

PWHL fans are purpose-driven consumers and **3x more likely to shop eco-conscious brands**, spending an average of \$725 per fan annually with environmentally aligned brands such as Lush and Patagonia. Their purchasing power reflects both passion and principle.

The PWHL Fan

PWHL fans are dynamic and well-rounded, balancing active lifestyles with thoughtful, values-driven choices. They're loyal to purpose-led brands like Ben & Jerry's, and you'll often find them at the Barnes & Noble Café, drink in hand and a new book in tow. From picking up essentials for their pets at PetSmart to outfitting their homes with Ikea finds, these fans combine comfort, conscience, and curiosity in everything they do.



Categories Where PWHL Fans Are Spending

Actual brands purchased by PWHL Fans as identified by the Genius Fan Graph

Category penetration among PWHL Fans

Recommended Audiences

- Pet Owners
- Chewy Subscribers
- Live Entertainment Seekers
- Concert & Festivalists
- Barstool Sports Engagers
- Cinema Goers
- Women's Sports OTT Subscribers
- Gen-Z Hockey Fans
- Values-Driven Women's Sports Fans
- Bookworms

ACTIVATION IDEA

Genius Audiences

With the PWHL season overlapping the busiest retail period of the year, brands can tap into a highly valuable audience to amplify holiday campaigns. By pairing the "women's hockey fans" attribute with "Black Friday shoppers," media buyers can activate a high-performing audience segment optimized for Q4 performance.

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NFL

Beauty Backers

Here's an opportunity for brands to connect with audiences beyond the traditional sports lens: **43% of NFL fans are beauty enthusiasts, each spending an average of +\$300/year on cosmetics & skincare.**

Gametime Gamblers

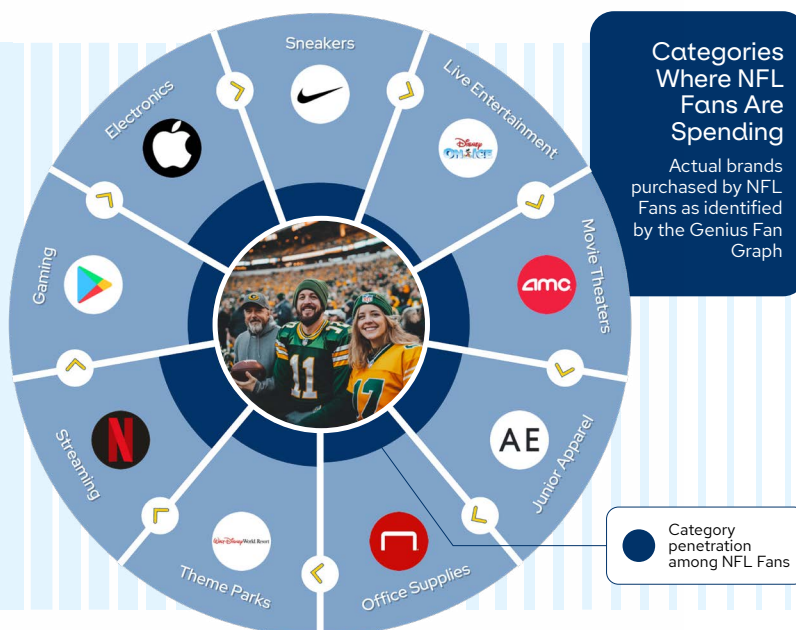
NFL fans are 3x more likely than the average consumer to gamble online, with bettors making an avg of 65 deposits with betting platforms per year.

Game Lovin' Gamers

NFL fans bring their love of the game to life across consoles and online gaming platforms, with **40% of NFL fans spending on gaming, and making around 2 gaming purchases per month.**

The NFL Fan

NFL fans are driven by competition in every form, whether they're building fantasy leagues, placing bets on FanDuel, or playing Madden on PlayStation. They're loyal to top brands like Apple for their tech and Disney World for unforgettable experiences that bring them closer to the action. With the season kicking off around back-to-school time, student fans stock up on new fits from American Eagle and upgrade their shoe game with Nike, reflecting a fanbase that blends tradition, style, and the spirit of play both on and off the field.



Recommended Audiences

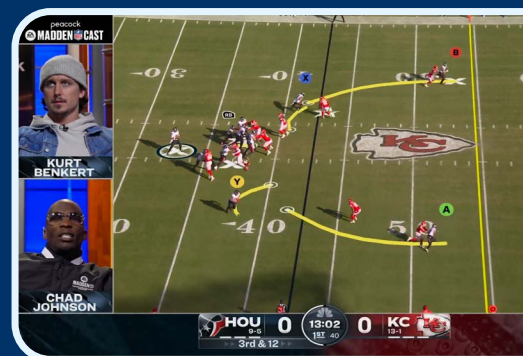
- Beauty Enthusiasts
- Salon & Spa Frequenters
- NFL Sports Bettors
- Back-to-School Shoppers
- Sneakerheads
- NFL Gamer Fans
- High-Value NFL Fans
- Swiftie NFL Fans
- Youth Sports Streaming Network Subscribers
- NFL Network Viewers & Official Merchandise Buyers
- Youth Football Parents

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ACTIVATION IDEA

Genius Stat View Custom

Building on innovations like Madden NFL Cast, which reimaged live action through fully customized gameplay-inspired visuals, Genius Stat View Custom brings bespoke route recreations, player identifiers, and momentum graphics to NFL broadcasts, giving brands an elevated, ownable presence during the league's most-watched moments.



College Sports Bowl Games

Activewear Shoppers

College Sports fans are ACTIVE! They're **2x more likely to buy activewear** built for performance and lifestyle.

Road Warriors

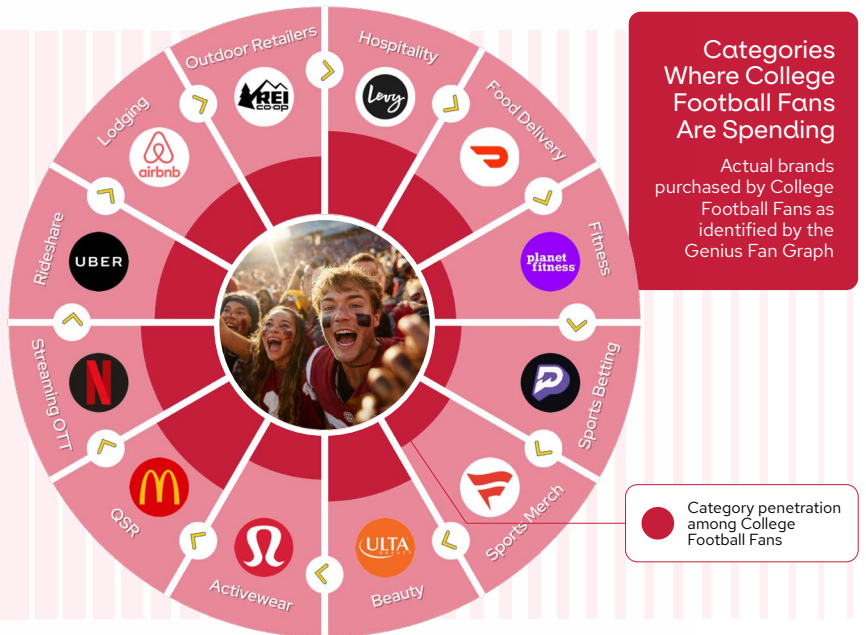
When the team hits the road, so do the fans! They averaged **\$4,701 in hotel spend per fan** in 2025.

Spirit Spenders

College football fans don't just show up—they suit up! They're **2x more likely to shop sports merch** than the average consumer.

The College Football Fan

The college football fan is fiercely loyal to their team, traveling across state lines and racking up Marriott Bonvoy points to catch every big game. They shop at outdoor and athleisure retailers at twice the rate of the general population, ensuring their game-day gear is ready for every high and low. And when they're streaming from home, DoorDash is their go-to for prime-time snacks and convenience.



Recommended Audiences

- Premium Performance Lifestyle
- High Value College Football Fans
- Mainstream Athleisure Powerhouses
- Elite Sports Performance
- High Value Fanatics Shoppers
- Yogis
- Domestic & International Airlines Customers
- DraftKings Bettors
- Sports Merchandise Shoppers
- Ulta Beauty Shoppers
- Tax Act Customers

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ACTIVATION IDEA

Genius Stories

Genius Stories transforms live college football data into dynamic social content that surfaces weekly matchups and standout moments, helping brands stay contextually relevant to fans who follow every storyline on every screen.



Super Bowl

Latte Loyalist

75% of Super Bowl fans are heavy coffee consumers, keeping up their energy for the Big Game weekend!

Community Coaches

Super Bowl fans are community sports enthusiasts, being **3x more likely to spend on youth and recreational sports**.

Home Improvers

For most Super Bowl fans, the home is how they experience the game. **Six out of 10 fans spend +\$1.2K per year at home improvement retailers**.

The Super Bowl Fan

Year over year, the Super Bowl has united more than a third of the US population by turning game day into a shared celebration of sport and pop culture. Whether they're flying Southwest to reunite with friends, booking Airbnbs for weekend watch parties, or relying on Uber Eats for halftime spreads, these fans go all in on the moment.



Categories Where Super Bowl Fans Are Spending

Actual brands purchased by Super Bowl Fans as identified by the Genius Fan Graph

Category penetration among Super Bowl Fans

Recommended Audiences

- Travel Youth Sports Parents
- Youth Sports Streaming Network Subscribers
- Adult Rec League Players
- Domestic Decorators
- IKEA Shoppers
- Premium Home Decor Shoppers
- Swiftie NFL Football Fans
- Gen Z NFL Football Fans
- NFL Football Fans Who Are Sports Bettors
- High Frequency Sports Merch Shoppers
- Home Chefs
- High-Value Food Delivery Subscribers
- Home Entertainers & Drinkers

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ACTIVATION IDEA

Audiences + Moments

Combine the quality of deterministic precision with moment-triggered creative to reach the right fan at the most captivating moments. Whether the action is up or down, pre-game or post, know who you're reaching and message them when they're ready to hear it!

Home Chef

AGE 42 HHI 150K
SHOPS Sur La Table, Hungry Root

CRISP

IT'S NACH-O-VERTIME!

Whip up a snack while fans whip into a frenzy!

GET THE FULL RECIPE NOW!

The Biggest Sporting
Event in Global History

World Cup 2026

6
Billion

The number of people FIFA estimates will engage with the World Cup

140
Super Bowls

The relative size of the World Cup in viewership

8 SEC Championships
in a row

The number of events, in a row, that will equal the host city fan engagement size

It's not IF they'll show up for the Cup

It's HOW

Only Genius Sports has addressable World Cup fan personas that allow brands to connect with distinct fan communities with precision at scale. Available as syndicated and custom audiences to allow your brand to customize the right message to the right fans.



International Fan

Consumers who purchase from global leagues, national team stores, attending or streaming international team games during major tournaments like the Olympics, or buying DTC from international leagues & teams.



Gamer Fan

Our World Cup/Gamer Fan has transacted with soccer merchants AND gaming consoles, retailers, publishers, and subscriptions such as PlayStation, Xbox, GameStop, EA Sports, and more.



Soccer Player

A current or former soccer athlete, our World Cup/Soccer Player audience includes consumers making transactions with adult recreational leagues, soccer gear and merchandise retailers, and active fitness brands.



Big Event Seeker

World Cup will attract a mass audience of "bandwagon" fans who won't miss the once-in-a-lifetime event. Our World Cup/ Big Event Seeker spends with major events like the Super Bowl, Kentucky Derby, US Open, and more.



Parent Fan

Includes consumers identified as having children in the HH and who spend on youth sports soccer merchants, collectibles, dedicated soccer streaming networks, or live soccer events.



Pop Culture Fan

From Ted Lasso to Welcome to Wrexham, soccer has become daily meme culture and the World Cup/Pop Culture Fan is subscribing to the media networks, podcasts, and premium content that hosts popular sports and soccer content.

Eliminate Waste With World Cup Market-Specific Audiences

As the World Cup lands across eleven different US cities, it presents a key opportunity to penetrate the sports fans, entertainment seekers, and World Cup Communities in each local market. We've developed custom, city-based audiences that include purchase behaviors against local teams at the professional, minor, and collegiate level, as well as big sports and entertainment events and stadium/venue purchases.



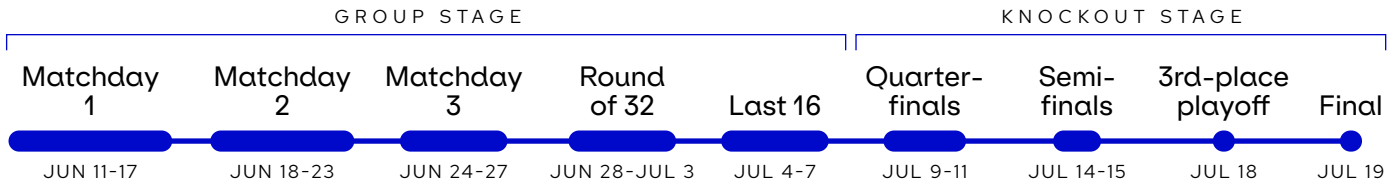
Sample of Sports & Entertainment Merchants Included in Custom City-Based Audiences

HOST CITY	TEAMS
Atlanta	Braves, Falcons, Hawks, United FC, Dream, Yellowjackets, Truist Park, Mercedes Benz Stadium
Boston	Bruins, Celtics, Red Sox, New England Patriots, New England Revolution, BOS Nation FC, Fenway Park, Gillette Stadium
Dallas	Cowboys, Renegades (XFL), Rangers, Frisco RoughRiders, Dallas Stars, Mavericks, Wings, FC Dallas, American Airlines Stadium, Globe Life Field, Cotton Bowl Stadium
Houston	Texans, Astros, Rockets, Dynamo, Dash, Sabercats (Major League Rugby), NRG Stadium, Minute Maid Park
Kansas City	Chiefs, Royals, Monarchs, Sporting Kansas City, KC Current, Arrowhead Stadium, Children's Mercy Park, CPKC Stadium
Los Angeles	Lakers, Sparks, Dodgers, Kings, Galaxy, Rams, LAFC, Angel City FC, SoFi Stadium, Rose Bowl Stadium, KIIS-FM Jingle Ball, 2028 Summer Olympics
Miami, Florida	F1, Heat, Marlins, Dolphins, Inter Miami CF, Kaseya Center, LoanDepot Park, Orange Bowl
New York/ New Jersey	Mets, Yankees, Giants, Jets, Knicks, Nets, Liberty, Rangers, Brooklyn FC, Brooklyn Cyclones, New York City FC, Madison Square Garden, Citi Field, MetLife Stadium, Red Bull Arena, Meadowlands, Gotham FC
Philadelphia	Eagles, Phillies, 76ers, Flyers, Citizens Bank Park, Lincoln Financial Field, Wells Fargo Center, Subaru Park
San Francisco Bay Area	Outside Lands, 49ers, Giants, Golden State Warriors, San Jose Sharks, San Jose Earthquakes, Golden State Valkyries, Levi's Stadium, Oracle Park, Chase Center
Seattle	Sounders FC, Seahawks, Mariners, Kraken, Storm, Seawolves, Reign FC, Lumen Field, T-Mobile Park, Climate Pledge Arena, Starfire Sports Complex

WORLD CUP 2026

Media Activation Cheat Sheet

When 2026 World Cup Calendar



▶ TRACK LIVE UPDATES TO THE SCHEDULE AT GOAL

Who Example Sponsor Category Audiences



Travel

- Budget Traveler
- Luxury Traveler
- Alternative Accommodation Spender (Airbnb, VRBO)
- Traveling Soccer Fans



Betting

- Cross Channel Bettors
- Casino Bettors
- Sports Bettors
- High-Value Sports Bettors



Snacks & Beverages

- Home Chef
- Soccer Moms
- Youth Sports Parents
- High-Value Snacks & Beverages Spender



Apparel & Athleisure

- Soccer Player
- High-Value Athleisure Spender
- Sneakerheads
- Runners



Financial Services

- High-Income World Cup Fans
- Tax Software Spenders
- Business Software Spenders
- Investors

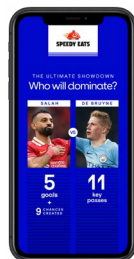
▶ EMAIL AUDIENCES@GENIUSSPORTS.COM FOR A FULL LIST OF WORLD CUP SEGMENTS

What



Genius Sports Moments

Addressable ads triggered at precise, emotion-driven moments before, during, or after the game.



Genius Sports Stories

Platform-ready content that brings fans the data-driven stories that are unfolding in real time throughout the World Cup.



Genius Sports Second Screen Games

From predictor games to trivia, second-screen games power interactive Cup journeys that expand inventory & collect audience insights.

▶ REQUEST MORE INFORMATION

Start Activating Today

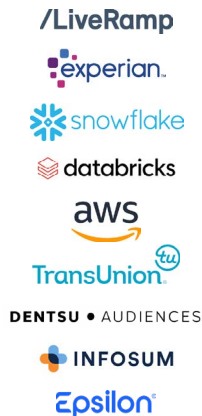
- 1** Access 1000+ exclusive Genius Sports syndicated audiences [here](#), covering every sport, league, team, emerging, and next-gen fan community. Also tap into retail and brand-based audiences across categories including Accessories, Apparel, Attractions, Auto, Beauty, Beverages, Cannabis & Vaping, Collectibles, Electronics, Finance, Fitness, Insurance, QSR, Retail, Restaurants, Snacks, Technology, Telco, Travel, and hundreds more.

TOP AUDIENCES IN 2025

- NFL Swiftie Fans
- Women's Sports Fans
- Fluid Fans & Gen-Z Fans
- International Sports Fans
- Big Sporting Event Fans
- Super Bowl Fans
- Women's March Madness Fans
- World Cup Fans
- Youth Sports Parents
- Values-Driven Fans
- Sober-Curious Fans
- Cross-Channel Sports Bettors
- High-Value OTT & Sports Streamers

- 2** Activate our audiences on any of the following DSPs and Marketplaces

PLATFORMS



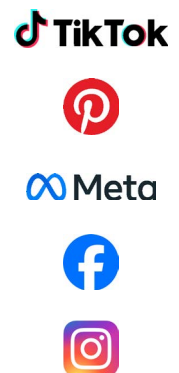
SSPs



DSPs



SOCIAL



- 3** Customize a dedicated audience for your campaign

With 10,000+ brands tracked in our Genius Fan Graph, our Audience Desk can design and model segments and push them to your preferred platform across display, digital OOH, mobile, OTT, CTV, and more.

EXAMPLE CUSTOM AUDIENCES



High-Value DoorDash purchasers who are NWSL Fans



NHL Fans that are Class Curators



Sober Curious MLB Fans

Email Audiences@geniussports.com to request your audience today!

